

D745

Student Teaching II in Elementary and Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A candidate plans a third-grade unit on measurement. The class has a class garden funded by a local grant, and the school mascot is a hawk. Which plan is truly project-based?

- A. Students answer “How can we design new garden beds that fit our space and budget?” and present plans to the principal.
- B. Students measure objects at stations each day.
- C. Students watch a video about gardens.
- D. Students complete two weeks of measurement worksheets, then build a model hawk.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A second grader with dyslexia still confuses short vowel sounds. He is very artistic and his family recently adopted a puppy. Which approach best fits multisensory structured literacy?

- A. Have him draw pictures of words he likes.
- B. Give him more independent reading time.
- C. Play a random mix of phonics games each day.
- D. Explicitly teach one vowel at a time; he says the sound while tracing the letter and tapping sounds in words, with daily cumulative review.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which activity is multisensory but NOT structured literacy?

- A. Students tap each sound in ‘ship’ while saying it.
- B. Students trace ‘sh’ in sand while saying /sh/ after explicit teaching.
- C. Students mold clay letters of their choice while music plays, with no link to a sound sequence.
- D. Students read a decodable text with taught patterns.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

During a running record, a first grader reads 'horse' for 'house' and 'bread' for 'bead.' She reads with expression and her favorite color is purple. Which cueing pattern does this show?

- A. She is using visual cues but neglecting meaning; prompt, "Does that make sense?"
- B. She has two errors, so her accuracy is fine and no analysis is needed.
- C. She is using meaning but not visual cues.
- D. She reads with expression, so she is using all cues well.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A reader says 'pony' for 'horse' in 'The horse ran fast.' Which cues did the reader use, and which did she neglect?

- A. Used no cues.
- B. Used visual; neglected meaning.
- C. Used structure only; neglected meaning and visual.
- D. Used meaning and structure; neglected visual.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A candidate starts daily number talks with fourth graders. Today's problem is 49×4 . The school recently repainted the gym, and it is picture day. Students offer three different strategies. What should the candidate do?

- A. Skip today because of picture day.
- B. Accept only the fastest answer.
- C. Record each strategy, such as $50 \times 4 - 4$, and ask students to compare how they are alike and different.
- D. Show the standard algorithm and ask everyone to use it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

After a great class play, a candidate takes a photo of five smiling students on stage. The play was about recycling and parents helped build the set. She wants to post it on her personal social media account. What should she do?

- A. Not post it; share through the school's approved channel only if media releases and policy allow.
- B. Post it with first names only.
- C. Post it, since it is a positive moment.
- D. Post it if parents who helped with the set agree in the comments.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which classroom photo could a teacher most likely share on the school's official page?

- A. A photo of a whiteboard listing students' reading levels.
- B. Any photo, since the page is official.
- C. A close-up of a student whose family opted out of media release.
- D. A photo of student hands building a model, with no faces or names, shared under district policy.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A candidate sees an instructional assistant, who has worked at the school for 12 years, grab a student with a disability by the arm and pull him hard down the hall. The assistant is well liked by staff. What should the candidate do?

- A. Let it go because the assistant is experienced and liked.
- B. Say nothing, since she is only a student teacher.
- C. Make sure the student is safe, then report what she saw to the cooperating teacher and administrator right away, following policy.
- D. Confront the assistant loudly in the hallway.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A candidate reported a colleague's unsafe practice to the principal. Two days later, nothing seems to have changed and the practice continues. What is the best next step?

- A.** Assume the principal handled it.
- B.** Tell her university supervisor and follow the district's next reporting step, documenting what she observed.
- C.** Never report again, since it did not work.
- D.** Post about it online.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

Near the end of student teaching, a candidate has trouble sleeping and feels anxious most mornings. She has a job offer for next fall and recently ran a half-marathon. Her district partner offers a free, confidential employee assistance program. What should she do?

- A.** Wait until summer when stress always goes away.
- B.** Contact the employee assistance program or a counselor now and tell her mentor she needs support.
- C.** Keep quiet so it does not affect her job offer.
- D.** Run more, since running helped before.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A candidate joins instructional rounds with three teachers to study how students talk in math. One teacher just returned from a trip to Peru and another coaches volleyball. After visiting a class, what should the group do?

- A.** Rate the teacher on a 1-4 scale.
- B.** Share specific, non-judging notes of what students said and did related to math talk.
- C.** Discuss everything they noticed, including decor and pacing.
- D.** Ask the traveling teacher to share photos from Peru.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A candidate plans a third-grade unit on measurement. The class has a class garden ~~funded by a local grant, and the school mascot is a hawk~~. Which plan is truly project-based?

Target word: identify genuine PBL **Decides:** A driving question requiring the content and a public product.

A	Correct	An open driving question requires measurement and ends in a public product.
B	Adjacent category	Hands-on practice, but no driving question.
C	Dropped element	Drops the driving question and product.
D	Camouflage	Uses the mascot; an end craft is not PBL.

2. Answer D Concept 2

A second grader with dyslexia still confuses short vowel sounds. ~~He is very artistic and his family recently adopted a puppy~~. Which approach best fits multisensory structured literacy?

Target word: what multisensory structured literacy looks like **Decides:** Explicit, sequenced phonics with simultaneous senses.

A	Camouflage	Uses the art detail; not explicit phonics.
B	Dropped element	Drops explicit instruction.
C	Confusion set	Active, but not systematic or sequenced.
D	Correct	Explicit, systematic instruction plus simultaneous seeing, saying, and moving.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

Which activity is multisensory but NOT structured literacy?

Target word: reverse: find what is missing **Decides:** Structured means explicit and sequenced.

A	Inverted operation	That is multisensory structured literacy.
B	Confusion set	Also both multisensory and structured.
C	Correct	Senses are used, but instruction is not explicit or sequenced.
D	Adjacent category	Structured practice; not the multisensory-only case asked.

4. Answer A Concept 3

During a running record, a first grader reads 'horse' for 'house' and 'bread' for 'bead.' ~~She reads with expression and her favorite color is purple~~. Which cueing pattern does this show?

Target word: classify errors **Decides:** Errors look like the word but do not make sense.

A	Correct	Substitutions share letters (visual) but do not fit the story (meaning).
B	Dropped element	Drops the cue analysis.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses it; the words look alike but do not make sense.
D	Camouflage	Expression does not mean she is checking meaning.

5. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

A reader says 'pony' for 'horse' in 'The horse ran fast.' Which cues did the reader use, and which did she neglect?

Target word: reverse: meaning-driven error **Decides:** 'Pony' fits meaning and structure but not print.

A	Absolute language	The substitution fits meaning and grammar.
B	Inverted operation	'Pony' does not look like 'horse.'
C	Dropped element	Drops meaning, which 'pony' keeps.
D	Correct	Makes sense and sounds right, but does not look like 'horse.'

6. Answer C Concept 4

A candidate starts daily number talks with fourth graders. Today's problem is 49×4 . ~~The school recently repainted the gym, and it is picture day.~~ Students offer three different strategies. What should the candidate do?

Target word: run a number talk **Decides:** Record and compare strategies.

A	Camouflage	Uses the schedule detail; a number talk takes minutes.
B	Confusion set	Values speed over reasoning.
C	Correct	Multiple strategies, recorded and discussed, build flexibility.
D	Inverted operation	Drills one method, the opposite of the goal.

7. Answer A Concept 5

After a great class play, a candidate takes a photo of five smiling students on stage. ~~The play was about recycling and parents helped build the set.~~ She wants to post it on her personal social media account. What should she do?

Target word: posting student photos **Decides:** Identifiable students on a personal account.

A	Correct	Personal accounts are not the place for identifiable student images.
B	Dropped element	Faces still identify students.
C	Adjacent category	Positive intent does not remove privacy concerns.
D	Camouflage	Uses the parents detail; comments are not formal consent for all five.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

Which classroom photo could a teacher most likely share on the school's official page?

Target word: reverse: acceptable sharing **Decides:** Policy plus releases plus no identifiers.

A	Confusion set	Shares private educational data.
B	Absolute language	Official channels still require releases.
C	Inverted operation	Directly against the family's choice.
D	Correct	Unidentifiable content on an approved channel fits policy.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A candidate sees an instructional assistant, ~~who has worked at the school for 12 years,~~ grab a student with a disability by the arm and pull him hard down the hall. ~~The assistant is well liked by staff.~~ What should the candidate do?

Target word: respond to harm **Decides:** A student was physically harmed.

A	Camouflage	Tenure and popularity do not justify harm.
B	Inverted operation	Silence fails the duty to protect.
C	Correct	Student safety first, then proper reporting.
D	Adjacent category	Public confrontation is not the proper channel.

10. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

A candidate reported a colleague's unsafe practice to the principal. Two days later, nothing seems to have changed and the practice continues. What is the best next step?

Target word: reverse: follow-through after reporting **Decides:** Duty continues; use the next level of the chain.

A	Dropped element	Drops follow-through while harm continues.
B	Correct	If harm continues, escalate through the chain and document.
C	Absolute language	One report does not end the duty.
D	Adjacent category	Not a proper channel and may breach privacy.

11. Answer B Concept 7

Near the end of student teaching, a candidate has trouble sleeping and feels anxious most mornings. ~~She has a job offer for next fall and recently ran a half-marathon.~~ Her district partner offers a free, confidential employee assistance program. What should she do?

Target word: use support resources **Decides:** Ongoing symptoms and a confidential resource.

A	Absolute language	Stress does not always resolve on its own.
B	Correct	Early, confidential help is a professional strength.
C	Inverted operation	Rests on the myth that seeking help is reported or weak.
D	Camouflage	Uses the half-marathon; exercise helps but does not replace support for ongoing symptoms.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A candidate joins instructional rounds with three teachers to study how students talk in math. ~~One teacher just returned from a trip to Peru and another coaches volleyball.~~ After visiting a class, what should the group do?

Target word: debrief norms **Decides:** Describe evidence tied to the focus question.

A	Adjacent category	That is evaluation, not rounds.
B	Correct	Rounds use descriptive evidence tied to a shared question.
C	Dropped element	Drops the focus question.
D	Camouflage	Irrelevant detail.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	The driving question in project-based learning	A PBL unit is organized around an open, meaningful driving question that requires the target content to answer and ends in a public product.	Calling a final craft or poster after regular lessons ‘a project.’	A unit plan claims to be project-based.
2	Multisensory structured literacy	Teach sound-symbol links explicitly and systematically while students see, say, and move (for example, tapping sounds or tracing letters) at the same time.	Thinking multisensory means adding fun activities without explicit, sequenced phonics.	A student with a reading disability is not learning letter-sound patterns.
3	Running record cueing analysis (MSV)	Classify each error by the cue the reader used: meaning (makes sense), structure (sounds right), visual (looks like the word), and teach toward the neglected cue.	Counting errors only, without asking what the reader was using.	A list of substituted words in a running record.
4	Number talks	Short daily sessions where students mentally solve a problem and share several strategies build number sense and flexible thinking; the teacher records, not corrects, strategies.	Using number talks to drill one fast method.	A teacher wants to try a new method to build mental math flexibility.
5	Student photos on social media	Do not post identifiable student images or work on personal accounts; follow district policy and media-release permissions for official channels.	Posting because the moment was positive or faces are partly turned.	A proud classroom moment and a phone.
6	Responding to a colleague’s harmful practice	When a colleague’s action harms or endangers students, act to protect the student and report through the proper chain, rather than ignoring it or confronting publicly.	Staying silent to keep peace, especially as a student teacher.	A candidate witnesses an adult’s unsafe or demeaning action.
7	Seeking support for stress	Using employee assistance programs, mentors, or counseling early is a professional strength and is confidential.	Believing asking for help will look weak or be reported.	A teacher has ongoing stress affecting sleep or mood.
8	Instructional rounds and peer observation	Observing colleagues with a focused question and describing evidence (not judging) builds shared practice.	Using peer visits to rate or evaluate the teacher observed.	A plan to watch other teachers teach.

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching II is the final part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. The course offers a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed in Student Teaching I, candidates receive ongoing feedback through observations and a final evaluation. This

evaluation assesses activities' relevance and cultural engagement, the effectiveness of teaching each student, the ability to analyze and adjust teaching methods, and the willingness to explore new materials and methods. Successful completion of Student Teaching II is a crucial step in the licensure process, as it determines eligibility for licensure as a professional educator. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve into professional development topics such as professional growth opportunities, ethical decision making, and self-care. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.